

After college, Thomas served four years in the Army during the Vietnam War. While he was there, his heart broke for the Vietnamese people who had nothing and practically no job prospects. After the war, he and three Army buddies started a farm co-op that now employs one hundred and twenty people. The co-op gives Vietnamese families a place to work and a steady income. Forty years later, the co-op is still running strong, and Thomas is excited to say there are third-generation co-op farmers working the fields today. He travels there twice a year and has personally donated more than \$250,000 to the project, which, he says, has been one of his best investments. He loves seeing the life-change that has occurred over three generations, and he's overwhelmed that he's been able to play such a big part in so many families' lives.

Now retired with a net worth of \$2.6 million, Thomas is looking back on the good work he's been able to do over the years while planning for even better work ahead. As a single guy with no kids, he's planning on spending the rest of his life giving away his wealth to causes he's passionate about. "When you help someone else," he said, "you forget about your own problems."

That kind of humble, incredibly generous spirit is contagious. That's the kind of person I want to be around. Heck, that's the kind of man or woman we should *all* want to become.